WEEKEND SPECIAL · MACRO LAYER

Does Macro Actually Move Bitcoin?

Sixteen years of data, answering the ten questions retail asks most

Uncle Onchain · Liquidity to Alpha

Weekend Special · Macro Layer

Data as of 2026-09-30 (weekly through 09-25)

"Hikes mean a crash, easy money means a rally, gold at new highs spills over, ETF inflows mean institutions are bullish" — test each claim against 16 years of data. Which ones hold up?

Every one of these sounds plausible, but very few people have actually tested them one by one. For this special we used every usable data point since Bitcoin's birth and checked each claim in turn. Some hold, some hold only half, and some point exactly the wrong way.

We tested at four time scales: one week, one month, one quarter to six months, and across several cycles. Since 2022, macro and cross-asset factors explain about a fifth of Bitcoin's weekly moves. Stretched to monthly, explanatory power rises, but what carries it is mostly **"US stocks"**, while rates and the dollar stay insignificant even monthly. Across cycles, how deep each of the five bear markets went has nothing to do with the size of the rate shock.

Macro governs Bitcoin's "tempo and risk," not its "direction." What

actually sets Bitcoin's direction is its own cycle.

76% Share of Bitcoin's weekly moves since 2022 that macro cannot explain	**0.94 → 0.08** M2 vs Bitcoin: correlation in levels vs in returns — the first is spurious	**−53%** Max drawdown of the current bear so far, in the same order as the five bear markets
0.60 ETF daily net inflow vs the past 3 days' move; vs the next 1–10 days only 0.04–0.07	**−27%** Bitcoin's median 13-week move when real rates spike and credit widens	**Neutral, leaning cautious** Overall read as of 2026-09-30: stay on guard

Three-minute summary

1. Before 2018 macro had almost no effect on Bitcoin. The link formed in two steps: in 2018 CME futures launched (Bitcoin began moving with the dollar and gold), and in March 2020 its market cap settled above $100 billion (it began rising and falling with the Nasdaq). The 2024 launch of spot ETFs brought no new change.
2. Since 2022, macro and cross-asset factors explain only a small part of weekly moves, and **76%** is unexplained. Monthly explanatory power rises to 58%, but adjusted it is only 46%, and shuffled data can produce about 38% by chance, so the part that truly beats coincidence is roughly 8% to 20%.
3. The five bear markets fell −93%, −85%, −84% and −77%, and the current one −53% so far: **depth follows the order of the cycles, not the size of the rate shock**. In 2022 real rates rose 2.8 percentage points, in 2018 only 0.6, yet 2022 fell less.
4. A hike does not always mean a drop. What decides the outcome is **whether credit is loose**: with real rates spiking and credit widening, Bitcoin's median 13-week move was **−27%**; with rates spiking but credit tightening, the median was only −3%.
5. M2's 0.94 is a spurious correlation, and only 1 of 14 "leads Bitcoin" pairings survived testing. Bitcoin is not a safe haven — it **falls with stocks but doesn't rise with them**. Gold at new highs shows no spillover, and the dollar points the right way but weakly.

6. ETF flows are a lagging, chase-the-price indicator, and heavy outflows are not a buy signal. Stablecoin growth follows price, not the other way around. No new money arrived over the last quarter: this is mostly existing holders changing venue.
7. The 2022 crash: the cycle was the root cause, hikes contributed about 31%–37% by dragging down US stocks, and crypto's own credit events contributed about 54%.
8. Now: the Fed hiked again on September 16, and the 10-year real rate at 2.93% is the highest since 2008. US stocks are optimistic, but high-yield spreads are widening and crypto-native money is leaving — **neutral, leaning cautious; stay on guard**.

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01

What data we used

- **Span**: July 2010 to September 2026, aligned to each Friday's close; mainly weekly, with monthly and daily data as supplements.
- **Bitcoin**: price, market cap, and MVRV (the ratio of market cap to holders' cost basis, a gauge of overall unrealized profit).
- **Macro**: US 10-year real rate, 2- and 10-year Treasury yields, the dollar index, the Fed's balance sheet and net liquidity, M2, and the assets of the five largest central banks.
- **Cross-asset**: Nasdaq, S&P 500, Russell 2000, the VIX, gold, oil, and inflation expectations.
- **Credit**: high-yield spreads, Moody's BAA corporate spreads, and the Chicago Fed financial conditions index.
- **Crypto money**: stablecoins (by coin and by chain) and the daily net flows of US spot Bitcoin ETFs.
- **Validation**: every conclusion went through a "coincidence test" (shuffle the data randomly several hundred times to see how large a relationship pure chance can produce) and was

checked by finding the pattern on the first half of the data and testing it on the second. We ran the data locally from official sources and from public mirrors, and the results matched exactly.

02

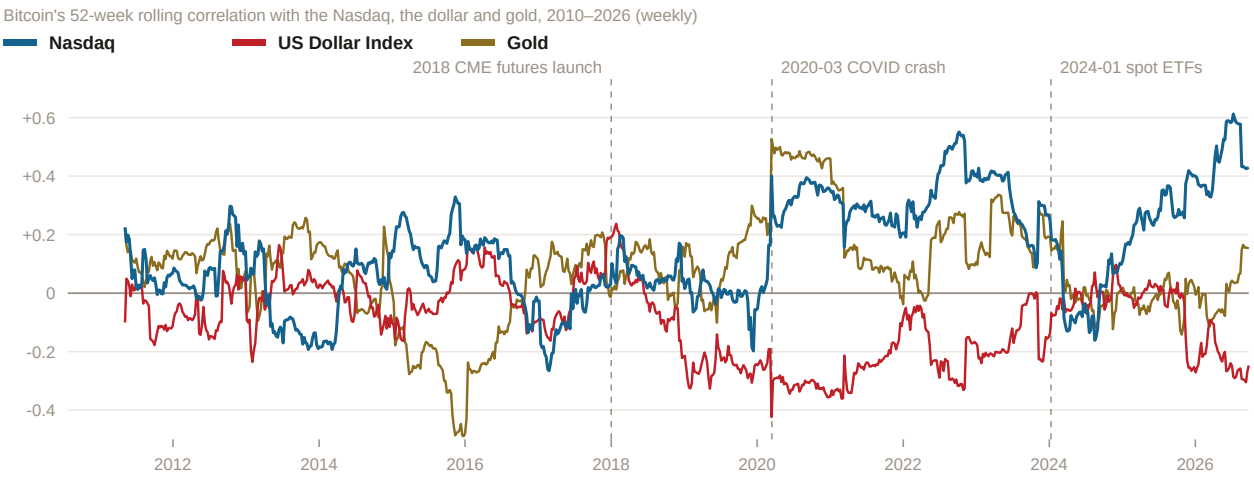
Three core findings

Finding 1: Bitcoin "plugged into" macro in two steps

Before 2018, macro had almost no effect on Bitcoin. Across 2010–2017, all macro and cross-asset factors combined explained less than "pure coincidence" would. The link formed in two steps:

- **Step one, 2018**: after CME Bitcoin futures launched, Bitcoin began moving with the dollar and gold.
- **Step two, March 2020**: around the COVID crash, Bitcoin's market cap settled above $100 billion and it began rising and falling with the Nasdaq.
- The 2024 launch of spot ETFs did not bring any new change.

Fig. 1 Bitcoin's 52-week rolling correlation with the Nasdaq, the dollar and gold — near zero before 2018, then plugged in to macro in two steps



Before 2018 all three lines hug zero; from 2018 the dollar and gold correlations start to move away from 0; around March 2020 the Nasdaq correlation rises clearly. (No rolling value for the first 52 weeks; series starts May 2011.)

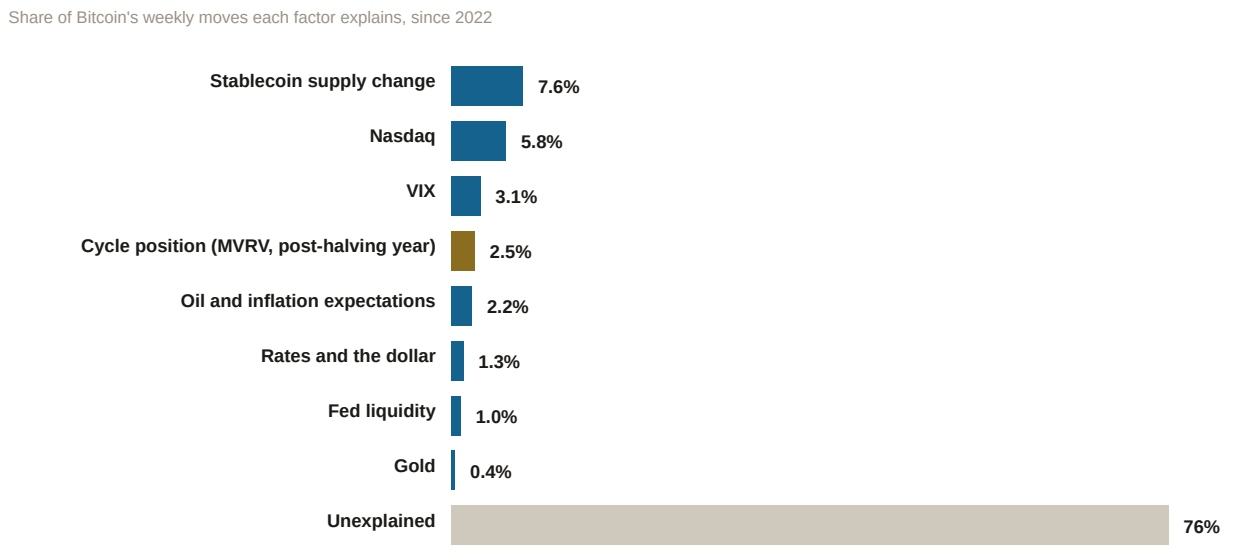
> **What it means for you** Any "macro rule" derived from pre-2018 data can't be used directly today.

Finding 2: Macro explains only a small part of Bitcoin's moves

Since 2022, the share of Bitcoin's weekly moves each factor can explain:

FACTOR	SHARE EXPLAINED
Stablecoin supply change	7.6%
Nasdaq	5.8%
VIX	3.1%
Cycle position (MVRV, years since the halving)	2.5%
Oil and inflation expectations	2.2%
Rates and the dollar	1.3%
Fed liquidity	1.0%
Gold	0.4%
Unexplained	**76%**

Fig. 2 Share of Bitcoin's weekly moves each factor explains — all combined still only about a fifth



Stretched to monthly, explanatory power rises to 58%, with the Nasdaq still first (16.6%) and rates plus the dollar together at 5.5%, not statistically significant.

Why not look only at weekly data? Macro is a slow variable, and weekly tests understate it. So we also tested the slow scales: monthly; one quarter to six months; letting liquidity and M2 lead Bitcoin by 0–16 weeks; and comparing bear-market depth across five cycles. The results agree: at slower scales the Nasdaq (market optimism) and the cycle matter more, while rates, the dollar and M2 still don't rank near the top. Also, the monthly sample has only 56 observations and 12 variables; after penalizing for the number of variables (adjusted R^2) it is 46%, and when we shuffle Bitcoin's data 500 times the same model can still produce about 38% by chance, so the part that truly beats coincidence is roughly 8% to 20%.

Is the Nasdaq "stealing" rates' explanatory power? No. Since 2022, weekly changes in real rates and weekly Nasdaq returns have moved in opposite directions (correlation −0.26), and every factor's variance inflation factor is below 2.3, far under the 5–10 at which collinearity usually becomes a worry. Real rates alone explain just 0.8% of Bitcoin's weekly moves; once the Nasdaq is added, rates add almost nothing. The decomposition method we use (Shapley) splits the overlap between two factors evenly, so it does not hand rates' whole share to the Nasdaq. "Hikes" and "stocks rising" happening together is a rare combination since 2022, which is why Question 1 uses a two-way scenario table instead of looking at each separately.

> **What it means for you** Watching the Fed and the dollar index all day for short-term trades captures only a small slice.

Finding 3: Cycle sets the direction, macro sets the tempo

Bitcoin's five bear markets fell −93%, −85%, −84% and −77%, and the current one −53% at its worst so far (taking June 30, 2026 as the provisional low). **The depths follow the order of the cycles exactly** and have nothing to do with the size of the rate shock. Even if this cycle makes a new low, the ordering won't change unless it falls below about $29,000 (−76.7% from the top, matching the last cycle).

Fig. 3 Max drawdown of the five bear markets — 2022, with the bigger rate shock, fell less

Max drawdown in each of Bitcoin's five bear markets, and the real-rate change in each



2022, with the bigger rate shock, fell less: depth follows the order of the cycles, not the size of the rate shock. Only a fall below about $29,000 (−76.7% from the top) would change the ranking.

- In 2022 real rates rose 2.8 percentage points and in 2018 only 0.6, yet 2022 fell less.
- In this 2025–26 bear market the Nasdaq actually rose 14%, and Bitcoin still fell 53% (so far).
- The three mature bull markets lasted almost exactly the same time (1,059–1,067 days), under wildly different macro conditions.

By horizon: within a week macro is more useful; at the one-quarter scale the cycle has a slight edge; at six months the two are about even.

03

Ten retail questions

Read each question in the same order: first the **common claim**, then **what the data says**, and finally **how to use it**.

Q1 Hikes | Q2 Liquidity | Q3 Digital gold | Q4 Gold spillover | Q5 The dollar | Q6 ETFs | Q7 Stablecoins | Q8 Who's selling | Q9 The 2022 crash | Q10 FOMC day | Bonus: Futures basis

Q1 Does a rate hike always mean a drop?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *Rates go up, money flees into Treasuries, so Bitcoin must fall.*

What the data says: only half right.

- Looking at weekly rate changes alone, there is almost no relationship with Bitcoin (correlation −0.09, not statistically significant).
- The current backdrop: the Fed began cutting in September 2024 and was still cutting into 2025; but in 2026 the economy turned strong, and on September 16 the Fed hiked again by 25 basis points to 3.75%–4.00%, its first hike since 2023. The 10-year real rate rose to 2.93%, the highest since 2008. So the "cutting cycle" is over, and a rate spike is the real environment now.
- Still, a real-rate spike of more than 0.4 percentage points within a quarter is an independent headwind: all else equal, Bitcoin gains roughly 15–20 percentage points less over the same period.
- What really decides the outcome is **whether credit is loose**. Since 2022, when real rates spiked:

	CORPORATE SPREADS TIGHTENING (MARKETS WILLING TO LEND)	CORPORATE SPREADS WIDENING (MARKETS AFRAID OF RISK)
Real rates spiked	Bitcoin's median 13-week move **−3%**, up 44% of the time	Median **−27%**, up only 15% of the time
Real rates did not spike	Median **+12.5%**, up 67% of the time	Median −7.6%, up 39% of the time

Splitting by US stock optimism instead: when rates spiked but US stocks were upbeat, Bitcoin's median move over the same period was still +27%.

> **How to use it** Don't panic at a hike — check credit spreads first. A rate spike plus widening credit is the truly dangerous combination.

Q2 Does Fed easing lift Bitcoin? Does "global liquidity leads Bitcoin by 2–3 months" hold up?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *M2 and global liquidity lead Bitcoin by about 10–12 weeks, so watching liquidity lets you position early.*

What the data says: it doesn't hold.

- M2 and Bitcoin "correlate at 0.94" only because both curves trend up over the long run — a spurious correlation; measured on returns, the correlation is just 0.08.
- We tested 14 "who leads Bitcoin" pairings, finding the pattern on the first half of the data and testing it on the second; only 1 passed.
- The lead-lag relationship with global central bank assets flips sign from era to era.
- Outside research agrees: the widely cited 0.94 is a levels correlation, and its original author never claimed a fixed lead time; another survey found the lead drifting between 1 and 3 months.

You can separate "the price of money" from "the quantity of money": real rates are the price, and Fed net liquidity (total assets minus the Treasury's account and reverse repo) is the quantity. Since 2022, at the one-quarter scale net liquidity has had an independent positive effect, but it has clearly weakened since May 2024.

> **How to use it** Treat liquidity only as a "discount condition": when liquidity is contracting fast and the dollar is strengthening, size down. It is not a directional signal, and certainly not a reason to position early.

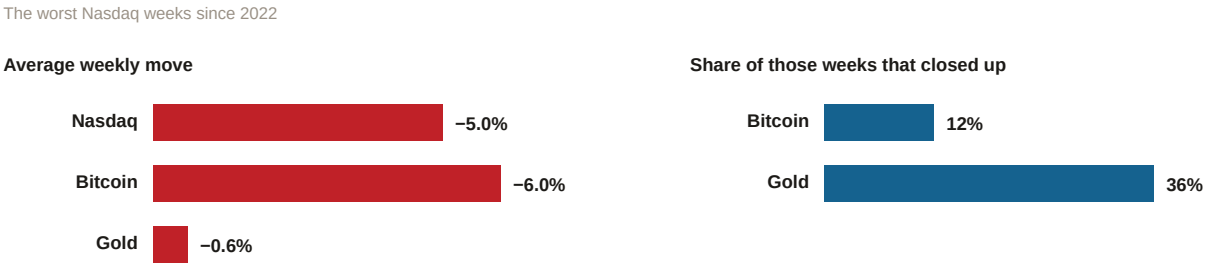
Q3 Is Bitcoin digital gold, a safe haven?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *When crisis hits, money hides in Bitcoin.*

What the data says: no.

- In the Nasdaq's worst weeks since 2022, the Nasdaq fell 5.0% a week on average and Bitcoin fell 6.0%, closing up in only 12% of those weeks; gold fell just 0.6% on average and closed up in 36% of them.
- Bitcoin **falls with stocks but doesn't rise with them**: when the Nasdaq falls 1%, Bitcoin falls 1.11% on average; when the Nasdaq rises 1%, Bitcoin rises only 0.39% on average.
- Outside academic research also finds that crypto assets and US stocks are "more tightly linked on the downside."

Fig. 4 Bitcoin and gold in the Nasdaq's worst weeks



In the Nasdaq's worst weeks Bitcoin fell even more than the index and closed up only 12% of the time; gold barely moved.

> **How to use it** In a week when US stocks weaken and the VIX rises, cut Bitcoin exposure first; don't expect it to strengthen on its own.

Q4 Gold hits a new high — does the money spill over into Bitcoin?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *After gold runs, it's Bitcoin's turn: "digital gold" catches up.*

What the data says: no stable evidence.

- We tested two common definitions of "gold at a high" (top 20% of six-month gains; near a one-year high). After either, Bitcoin's 13-week performance pointed the opposite way, and neither had an independent sample. Both definitions fail, which tells us there is only noise in there.
- From January 2025 to January 2026, gold rose 81% while Bitcoin fell 14%.
- The link between Bitcoin and gold existed only in 2018–2021 and has not been significant since 2022.

> **How to use it** Don't use gold's moves as a directional basis for Bitcoin.

Q5 Is a stronger dollar bearish?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *The dollar index is a contrarian indicator for Bitcoin.*

What the data says: right direction, weak force.

- Since 2022, the weekly correlation between the dollar index and Bitcoin is only −0.15, with explanatory power under 1%.
- This inverse relationship only began in 2018.

> **How to use it** Use the dollar only as a "confirming signal," not as the main basis.

Q6 Do ETF inflows mean institutions are bullish? Are big outflows a buy signal?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *ETF creations are real money, "harder" than social-media sentiment, so sustained inflows are evidence of institutional bullishness; heavy outflows mean panic and a contrarian buying opportunity.*

What the data says: the first half is right, the rest is wrong.

- ETFs are not just institutions. Public quarterly institutional holdings disclosures show institutions have always been a minority, with most holders being retail and small advisory accounts.
- Some of the money is hedge funds running a "basis trade": buy the ETF and short futures at the same time, earning the spread between the two, with no view on direction.
- **ETFs chase price**: a day's net inflow correlates at a high 0.60 with Bitcoin's move over the past 3 days, and almost not at all (0.04–0.07) with its move over the next 1–10 days. The same holds in 2024, 2025 and 2026.
- **Heavy outflows are not a buy signal**: in the 20% of weeks with the largest outflows, Bitcoin fell an average 3.5% over the following 4 weeks, versus a gain of 1.9% across all weeks. There was no rebound after heavy outflows.
- After weeks of heavy inflows, Bitcoin rose an average 6.6% over the next 4 weeks. The direction is "continuation," not "reversal," but the difference is not statistically significant, so treat it as a reference only.

Fig. 5 ETF daily net inflow vs Bitcoin's move: it tracks only moves that have already happened

US spot Bitcoin ETF daily net inflow: which period's BTC move does it track? (correlation)



ETFs chase price: flows follow moves that have already happened and have almost no predictive power for the next few days (same in 2024, 2025 and 2026).

> **How to use it** Use ETF flows to confirm the current trend; they are a lagging indicator. Don't treat outflows as a buy signal, and don't treat inflows as evidence that institutions are bullish.

Q7 Stablecoin supply is growing — does that mean new money is coming?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *Money enters crypto along the path "fiat → stablecoins → buy coins"; stablecoin growth happens at step one, so it shows money moving early.*

What the data says: two problems.

First, price rises first and stablecoins grow after. Since the ETF launch:

STABLECOIN GROWTH VS…	4 WEEKS	13 WEEKS
Bitcoin's **past** move	**0.49**	**0.60**
Bitcoin's move over the same period	0.41	0.52
Bitcoin's **future** move	−0.11	−0.26

Stablecoin growth is most strongly tied to past gains and unrelated to future gains. What actually happens is that people swap into stablecoins to enter after price has already risen.

Second, the stablecoin total contains a lot of money that isn't here to buy coins.

COMPONENT	SIZE	CHANGE OVER THE PAST YEAR	RELATIONSHIP WITH BITCOIN IN THE ETF ERA
Stablecoins on Tron (remittances, payments,	$94.0B	+$17.5B (+23%)	Weak: weekly correlation 0.00, 13-

and also USDT that exchanges keep on Tron plus OTC on-ramps)			week 0.15; over the full 2022–2026 span, 13-week 0.55
Payments / compliant-institution stablecoins (PYUSD, RLUSD, USDG, etc.)	$12.2B	2.8× a year ago	Inverse (13-week correlation −0.43)
Yield-bearing / synthetic stablecoins (USDe, USDS, etc.; some are minted against USDC collateral and so double-count with USDC)	$19.7B	Down by a third	Moves with on-chain leverage
Trading stablecoins on exchanges and major chains (USDT, USDC, etc., excluding Tron)	$170.8B	**−$7.5B (−4.2%)**	Positive (13-week 0.52)

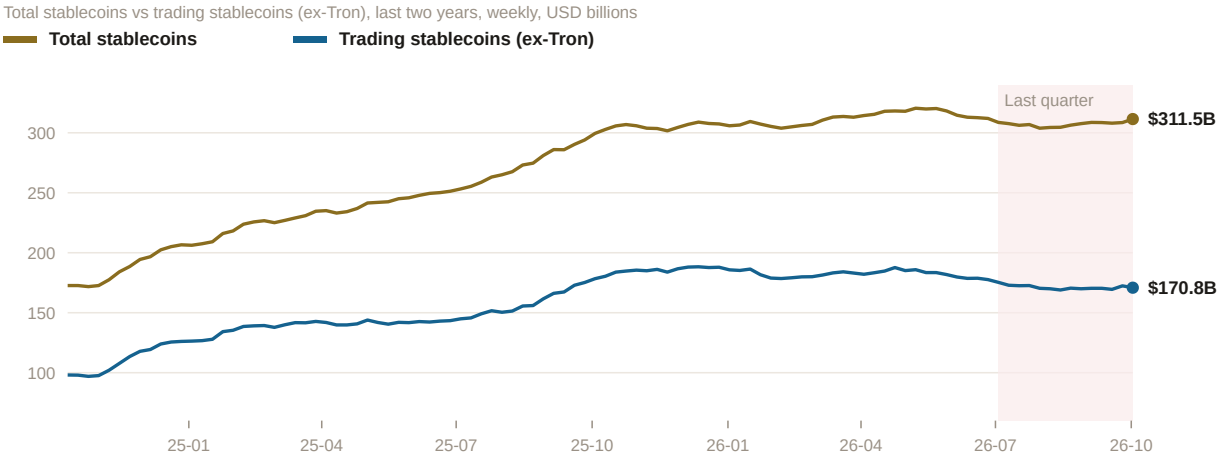
Not all USDT on Tron is remittances: retail users in Asia and Latin America often use it for OTC on-ramps, and exchanges also park large USDT balances on Tron. So part of it is money to buy coins and part is not, and on-chain data can't separate them. We show both bases side by side:

TRADING STABLECOINS (USDT, USDC, FDUSD, ETC.)	LAST QUARTER	LAST YEAR
Including Tron	+$0.5B (+0.2%)	+$10.0B (+3.9%)
Excluding Tron	−$4.6B (−2.6%)	−$7.5B (−4.2%)

On either basis the conclusion is the same: **no new money came in over the last quarter** — flat including Tron, shrinking excluding Tron. The total is up 4% in a year, mostly from Tron and payments-institution stablecoins.

Also, tokenized US stocks are still small (about $2.5 billion in market cap, under 1% of stablecoins) and have almost no effect on the stablecoin data.

Fig. 6 Total stablecoins vs trading stablecoins (ex-Tron) — the total is still up about 4% over a year, while trading stablecoins have turned down



Total supply is up about 4% in a year, while trading stablecoins (ex-Tron) are down $7.5B over the year and $4.6B over the last quarter. Data through 2026-10-02.

> **How to use it** Don't watch the stablecoin total; watch trading stablecoins, with both the including-Tron and excluding-Tron lines side by side. Use them only as confirmation, never as a reason to position early.

Q8 ETFs are buying and stablecoins are shrinking — so who is selling?

What the data says: over the past 13 weeks, ETFs took in about $5.96 billion net; trading stablecoins excluding Tron fell about $4.56 billion, and including Tron they rose only about $0.5 billion.

That says this stretch was **mostly existing holders changing venue, not a large wave of new money**: crypto money on-chain did not grow, and buying came mainly through the ETF channel.

To be clear, what changed is the **channel**, not the **crowd**. As Question 6 showed, ETF buyers include plenty of retail and advisory accounts and also hedge funds running basis trades. So "existing holders changing venue" means money moving from on-chain and exchanges into ETFs held in US brokerage accounts. The buyers may be the same kind of people, but where price gets set has changed. Since 2024 the weekly correlation between ETF flows and Bitcoin's weekly move is 0.67, versus only about 0.3 for stablecoins: marginal pricing power now sits in the ETF channel.

How to tell new money from a venue change:

ETF	TRADING STABLECOINS	MEANING

Inflow	Growing	Genuinely new money — both channels getting fresh capital
Inflow	Shrinking or flat (now)	**Venue change** — on-chain money moving into the ETF channel
Outflow	Growing	Reverse venue change, rare
Outflow	Shrinking	Genuine exit

> **How to use it** In a venue-change market, once ETFs turn to outflows there is no native money underneath, and the fall comes faster than the rise — the same thing as Question 3's "falls with stocks but doesn't rise with them." Who is actually selling to the ETFs (long-term holders or short-term speculators) needs on-chain data, which we'll cover in the next special on the cycle layer.

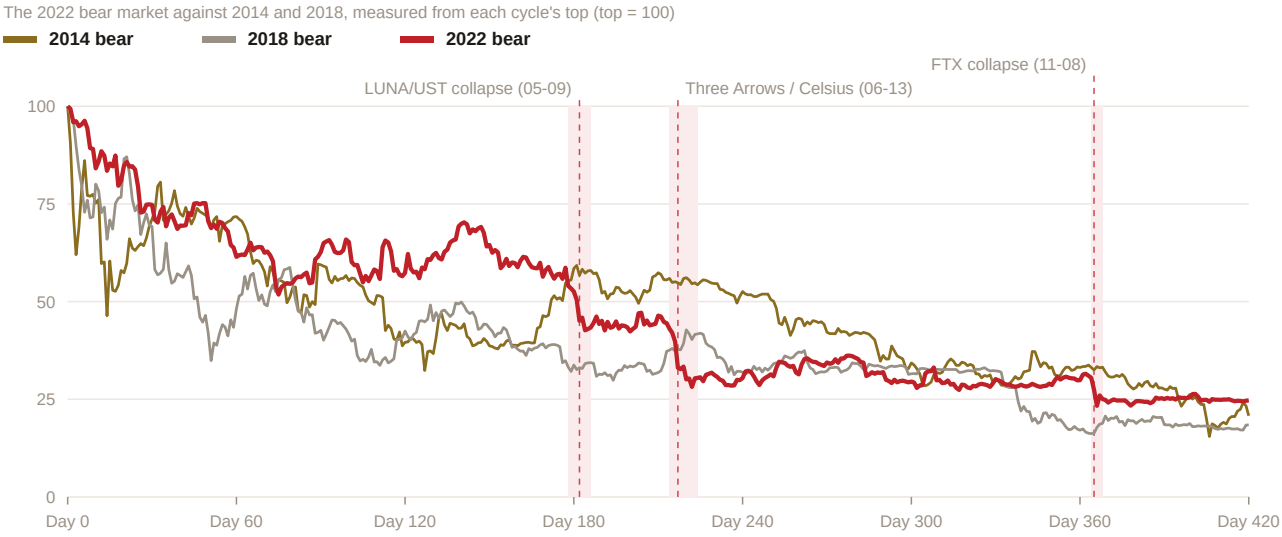
Q9 Did rate hikes cause the 2022 crash?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *The Fed's aggressive hikes knocked Bitcoin down.*

What the data says: hikes were an amplifier, not the root cause. We broke the 2022 decline apart:

- **The cycle was the root cause**: the depth and duration of the 2022 decline fall within the range of the 2014 and 2018 bear markets.
- **Hikes contributed about 31%–37% by dragging down US stocks**.
- **Crypto's own credit events contributed about 54%**: the LUNA collapse, the Three Arrows Capital blow-up, and FTX's failure.
- In the half-year of the sharpest hikes (November 2021 to May 2022), Bitcoin actually fell more slowly than in past bear markets; the pace picked up with the credit events of May–June.

Fig. 7 The 2022 bear market against 2014 and 2018, with LUNA, Three Arrows and FTX marked



In the half-year of the sharpest hikes, 2022 ran above the other two bears on most days; after LUNA and Three Arrows in May–June it fell back to roughly where they were, and it bottomed around FTX.

> **How to use it** Whether a bear market comes and how deep it goes depends on the cycle; hikes only decide how smooth the fall is.

Q10 How should you trade on FOMC day? Is a cut bullish?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *Cuts are bullish and hikes bearish; on meeting day, trade with the direction.*

What the data says: we looked at 7 key hike and cut events; Bitcoin's direction over the following 3–12 months didn't match the direction of policy. Seven is too few to prove FOMC meetings are unrelated to Bitcoin; what we can say is that the rule "cuts mean up, hikes mean down" has no support in history. After the same first hike, Bitcoin could rise 71% or fall 39% over the next 12 months; after cuts, it could rise 64% over 3 months (September 2024) or fall 26% (September 2025). Direction is set by where in the cycle you are.

> **How to use it** On meeting day, adjust only position size (volatility will rise); don't use the meeting to call direction.

Bonus Which futures premium should you use?

> **COMMON CLAIM** *Many sites use the premium on Deribit's quarterly contracts as a stand-in for the CME premium, calling it "the same measure."*

What the data says: it's the same concept in different markets: Deribit is mostly crypto-native leveraged money, while CME is US institutions and basis-trade money, and their absolute levels often differ by several percentage points.

> **How to use it** Better to read the two side by side: if both premiums are high, crypto and institutions are both adding leverage; if only CME is high, it's most likely basis-trade money and doesn't mean bullishness.

04

What to watch now

> **Where macro sits: macro is a throttle, not a steering wheel.** It decides how large a position you should hold over the next few weeks and how much volatility you can take; direction comes from Bitcoin's own cycle.

Five daily readings (as of September 30, 2026)

THE QUESTION	WHAT TO WATCH	NOW
Where are we in the cycle	Months since the halving, MVRV	Month 29 since the halving; MVRV 1.57, neutral; about 3 months from this cycle's low (June 30)
Is the market upbeat	Nasdaq 13-week move, VIX, corporate spreads	US stocks optimistic (Nasdaq 100 +4% over a quarter, VIX 16); but credit is diverging: long-dated corporate spreads are still tightening, while the high-yield spread widened by almost 0.5 percentage points in a single week in late September
What state are rates in	Level and 13-week change of the 10-year real rate	2.93%, highest since 2008, up 0.67 percentage points over a quarter: **spiking** (the Fed hiked again on September 16)

Does liquidity need a discount	Fed net liquidity + the dollar	Net liquidity −0.7% over 13 weeks, dollar on the weak side: no discount
Is crypto money confirming	Trading stablecoins, ETF inflows	**Diverging**: ETFs are taking in money, while trading stablecoins are shrinking excluding Tron and flat including Tron

Overall read: neutral, leaning cautious; stay on guard. Rates are still spiking at their highest since 2008, which is a headwind in itself; US stocks are optimistic and holding things up, but high-yield spreads are widening fast and crypto-native money is leaving.

What would turn it into a headwind: corporate spreads (Moody's BAA) or the financial conditions index tightening over a quarter; or the Nasdaq turning down over a quarter with the VIX rising above 20. If either happens we land in the "rate spike + credit tightening" cell — in which, since 2022, Bitcoin's median 13-week move was −27%.

05

Claims you can stop believing

THE CLAIM	WHAT THE DATA SAYS
The real rate is Bitcoin's most important macro variable	Weekly changes alone aren't significant; over the same period the Nasdaq and net liquidity both relate more strongly
Liquidity/M2 leads Bitcoin by 2–3 months	Only 1 of 14 lead relationships survived testing; M2's 0.94 is a spurious correlation
Bitcoin tops line up with real-rate lows	The five tops sat a median 96 days from the rate low; picking dates at random also gives 110 days — pure coincidence
Gold at new highs spills over into Bitcoin	The two definitions point opposite ways; over one year gold +81%, Bitcoin −14%
Cuts are bullish, hikes are bearish	After 7 events the direction didn't match, and there is no evidence for the rule; direction follows the cycle

Bitcoin is a safe haven	In the worst weeks for US stocks, Bitcoin fell even more than stocks
Heavy ETF outflows are a buy signal	After heavy outflows, Bitcoin kept falling an average 3.5% over the next 4 weeks
Stablecoin growth shows money entering early	Price rises first and stablecoins grow after

06

Limits and disclaimer

- Correlation is not causation; most of the above are "happened together" relationships, not predictions.
- Cycle conclusions rest on only 3–5 cycles and are directional evidence. Event samples such as FOMC meetings (7) and gold highs are smaller still; the text uses them only to show that "no evidence supports a given claim," never to forecast.
- The low of the 2025–26 bear market (June 30, 2026) is the provisional low so far and still awaits confirmation by time; wherever the text uses it, it is marked "so far."
- Macro is a slow variable and weekly data alone understates it, so this piece also gives monthly, quarter-to-half-year and cross-cycle results; conclusions rest on what agrees across scales.
- How much of the stablecoin supply on Tron is money to buy coins can't be separated on-chain, so trading stablecoins are shown on two bases: including and excluding Tron.
- ETFs have only about two years and nine months of data, so some conclusions rest on limited samples; where results are not statistically significant, the text says so.
- This is research sharing, not investment advice.

> Put the numbers together and macro's role is clear: **it sets the tempo and the risk, not the direction**. Use it to judge how large a position to hold over the next few weeks and how much volatility you can take, but don't

expect it to tell you "up or down" — the direction comes from Bitcoin's own cycle.

Where the cycle actually stands, and who is selling to the ETFs (long-term holders or short-term speculators), has to be answered with on-chain data. That is the job of the next special on the cycle layer.

Current read: **neutral, leaning cautious; stay on guard**. The real rate at 2.93% is still spiking at its highest since 2008; watch two signals for a turn to headwind — **credit tightening**, or the Nasdaq turning down with the VIX above 20.

Product-minded: I follow who is paying.
Macro liquidity → BTC holder structure → sector rotation → launchpads / low-base narratives
Public trading plan Monday to Friday — wrong calls included
Data and post-mortems only; not investment advice

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Data sources: CoinMetrics, FRED (St. Louis Fed), DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Farside, Yahoo Finance, Chicago Fed, ICE. External research cross-checks: MDPI "Interconnections Between Financial Markets and Crypto-Asset Markets" (2026), Economics Letters (2024), Finance Research Letters (2022), Lyn Alden's global liquidity research (2024).

This is research sharing, not investment advice. Correlation is not causation, past data does not predict the future, and you should judge for yourself and bear your own risk.